Berner Fachhochschule
Haute école spécialisée bernoise
Bern University of Applied Sciences

Team briefing for the memo and the slides

Rules that decide points, roles and deadlines

Item	Details
Institution	Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)
Course	EAIF: AI for Finance, Autumn Semester 2026
Group	Group_8 (Beyeler Fabian, Lussi Laurin, Griessen Jan)
Document type	Briefing for the writing lead and the slides
Key dates	Coaching Tue 24 Nov 2026; memo, notebook, results.json and peer evaluation Fri 27 Nov 2026, 23:59; slides Mon 7 Dec 2026, 23:59; presentation Tue 8 Dec 2026

> **Purpose.** A two-page orientation: what the assignment is, what to read first, the rules that decide points, the memo order and the deadlines.

What this is

A graded group assignment worth 100 points, one score for the group. We get simulated data about 1,376 companies (ESG scores and stock returns) and have to check it for errors, forecast returns, test whether good environmental scores paid, and test a trading strategy. **You do not need to code.** The notebook is built by the notebook owner, with AI help. You turn its results into the memo and the slides. Everyone must be able to explain what the notebook does, because the peer evaluation and the presentation can change individual scores.

Read first (about 45 minutes)

- **Coaching_Explainer_AS_2026.pdf**: the big picture, the four tasks, sections 1 to 5 and the glossary. The key idea is *leakage*: using information that the investor did not have at the time.
- **Group_assignment_AS_2026_transcription.md** (the assignment text): tasks (a) to (e), grading table and rules.
- Both are in the repo folder group_project_AS2026/docs/. Results sheets will appear in group_project_AS2026/results_sheets/.

Rules that decide points

- **Every number appears next to the baseline it must beat** (the naive average forecast for models, the equal-weight benchmark for the backtest).
- **Every figure has labelled axes with units.** Every feature is dated (the date from which it is known).
- **Say that the data is simulated** and cite it with its licence: "Simulated ESG and stock-return dataset, EAIF course, Autumn Semester 2026, CC BY 4.0", https://github.com/umatter/EDFB/tree/main/data/esg2026. Put it in the memo and on the slides.
- **Memo: 3 pages including tables and figures** (the lecturer confirmed), plus an appendix of any length. Group name and members on page 1.
- **No overclaiming.** A result like "the model does not beat the baseline" is accepted and graded as such. Write a claim only after the number behind it was checked.
- **Explain what each number means for an investor**, not only the number. Use size words that match the numbers.

Memo order (Word, 3 pages)

- 1. The question. 2. The data (simulated, licence). 3. The audit and the pipeline: features, the date from which each is known, the split.
- 4. Results of tasks (b), (c), (d), each metric next to its baseline.
- 5. A section titled **"What would change with real data"**: what remains unsolved after our audit (ESG scores are proprietary and raters disagree, survivorship is harder to see, trading costs are not constant, point-in-time availability) and, the larger part, which of our conclusions would survive and which would not, and why. Worth 15 points.
- 6. Group members and their roles.

Teammate B: writing lead

By	Deliverable
Sun 8 Nov	Memo skeleton in Word with the six headings. Data section with the simulated-data statement and licence line.
Wed 11 Nov	Audit paragraph (uses results sheet (a)).
Sun 15 Nov	Pipeline and model sections. Outline of "What would change with real data".
Sun 22 Nov	Complete memo draft (results sections from sheets (c) and (d)).
Tue 24 Nov	Coaching with the draft.
Thu 26 Nov	Final memo as PDF. Peer evaluation filled in. Submit evening.

Teammate C: analysis lead and slides

The talk is **8 minutes plus about 2 minutes of questions**, so plan 6 slides, about 1 to 1.5 minutes each. The lecturer asked for one slide that explains the audit: the problems found and how we treated them.

Slide	Content	Minutes
1	Question and data (state: simulated, licence)	1:00
2	Audit and pipeline: problems found, how treated	1:30
3	Model comparison: linear vs ensemble vs baseline	1:30
4	Where does ESG pay: region and period table	1:15
5	Backtest with ESG floor: table and cumulative return figure	1:30
6	What would change with real data	1:15

By	Deliverable
Sun 8 Nov	Slide skeleton in PowerPoint (6 slides, headings only).
Wed 11 Nov	Audit slide draft.
Sun 15 Nov	Model comparison slide.
Sun 22 Nov	Complete draft deck (also tables and figures with labelled axes and units).
Tue 24 Nov	Draft deck shown at the coaching.
Sat 5 and Mon 7 Dec	Two timed rehearsals. Final PDF by Mon 7 Dec noon (deadline 23:59).
Tue 8 Dec	Presentation.

What you get from the notebook owner

- After each task: a **one-page results sheet** (the numbers, each next to its baseline, with suggested wording) and a **plain-language guide** to what the code did.
- A **30-minute walkthrough** on Sun 8, Sun 15 and Sun 22 Nov. After each one, write three sentences in your own words about what was done and why. If you can do that, you can answer questions on it.
- If a number looks odd, ask before you write it down.

Everyone

- All three of us must be able to answer questions on every slide and every part of the notebook, in plain terms.
- Each student fills in the **peer evaluation** on Moodle by the memo deadline.
- Coaching with the lecturer: **Tue 24 Nov**. Bring the draft memo and draft deck.